dignáre: ut, qui nos cínerem esse, et ob pravitátis nostræ demérítum in púlverem reversúros cognóscimus; peccatórum ómnium véniam, et præmía pœniténtibus repromíssa, misericórditer consequi mereámur. Per Christum Dóminum nostrum. ℟. Amen.

know that we are but ashes and for the guilt of our fall shall return to dust, may be worthy to obtain, through Thy mercy, the forgiveness of all our sins and the rewards promised to the penitent. Through Christ our Lord. ℟. Amen.

Let us pray

ORÉMUS. Deus, qui humiliatióne flécteris et satisfactióne placáris: aurem tuæ pietátis inclína précibus nostris; et capítibus servórum tuorum, horum cínerum aspersióne contáctis, effúnde propítius grátiam tuæ benedictiónis: ut eas et spíritu compunctiónis répleas, et quæ juste postuláverint efficáciter tríbuas; et concéssa perpétuo stabilíta, et intácta manére decérnas. Per Christum Dóminum nostrum. ℟. Amen.

O GOD, Who art moved by humiliation and appeased by penance, incline the ear of Thy goodness to our prayers, and when the heads of Thy servants are touched with these ashes, graciously pour forth the grace of Thy blessing, that Thou mayest fill them with the spirit of compunction and mayest effectually grant what they righteously ask, and ordain that what Thou grantest may remain forever established and unmoved. Through Christ our Lord. ℟. Amen.

Let us pray

ORÉMUS. Omnípotens sempitérne Deus, qui Ninivítis in cínere et cilício pœniténtibus, indulgéntiæ tuæ remédia præstitísti: concéde propítius; ut sic eos imitémur hábitu, quátenus véniæ prosequámur obténtu. Per Dóminum. ℟. Amen.

ALMIGHTY, eternal God, Who didst bestow the healing of Thy pardon upon the Ninivites when they repented in ashes and sackcloth, mercifully grant that we may so imitate them in behavior as to be like them in obtaining pardon. Through our Lord. ℟. Amen.

He sprinkles the ashes thrice with holy water, saying the Asperges me. *Then he incenses them, afterwards sprinkling them in the figure of a cross, on his own head, and on the heads of the clergy and people, admonishing each one in these words:*

MEMÉNTO, homo, quia pulvis es, et in púlverem revertéris.

REMEMBER, O man, that thou art dust and unto dust thou shalt return.

Meanwhile the choir chants one or more of the following antiphons:

http://ccwatershed.org